

Title: I don't understand wave management.

Score:

--- POST CONTENT ---

Like I understand how freezes, slow pushes, and fast pushes work, but I can't quite get it to work. For context, I'm a Sylas main in mid, my ELO is embarrassingly Bronze 4, and I just started a few months ago. I've heard that slow pushing, is ideally your default push, and something you should always do. But whenever I attempt to only last hit/slow push in mid, the enemy laner just clicks Q and demolishes my entire wave, causing the entire enemy wave to crash into my tower/me and creates bad pressure. I've seen that I also should avoid using abilities on waves, so I don't, but it ends up messing with me in the end.

What do I do then, if I can't slow push because of enemy wave clear, do I just fast push (the worst wave state, from what guides have told me)? The one solution I've found for me is just creating pressure through trades, so they can't clear the wave without overstepping, since Sylas excels in trading. Any other tips? It just seems so off when I see all these guides and reddit posts preaching about slow pushes but they just never work for me.

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 30]

Not what you asked about, but your elo is never embarrassing. You are where you are.

Nothing wrong with being a lower rank, you learn at your own pace. You got this champ

[Comment 2 | Score: 66]

Wave management is mainly a concept for top and bot, while it technically exists mid it's the least important lane for it, being the shortest lane in the game and filled with ranged champions with strong waveclear reduce the importance of knowing it there.

[Comment 3 | Score: 13]

If the other guy is aware of wave management (in low elo sometimes they're not), sometimes you can't do anything to the wave. In your example of Sylas, usually melee mids have a lot of trouble managing the wave because you usually have to walk up to clear the wave. Even though you might have better waveclear than some champions like Leblanc, it's so dangerous for you that you can't do it without losing a ton of HP. Or they're just a mage and they have a ton of waveclear. The exception is champs like Ekko because his Q is great waveclear and is ranged. In top lane it's like if you're against a Darius, he will just kill you if you try to clear the wave because his all-ins are so strong.

Basically in some matchups it's hard to get wave control. The situation will affect it though, like if you're ahead and they're scared of trading with you, you can zone them out and then use your spells on the wave before backing up while you're cooldowns are down.

Like a very realistic scenario is let's say you're Sylas vs Veigar. Levels 1 and 2 are probably hard for you to do anything unless you find a way to hit E so you probably get pushed in. Eventually second or third wave he will crash the wave under your tower and you're forced to CS under tower while he tries to poke you. Now on the next wave, your wave is slowly pushing into him. Here because you have minion wave advantage and they don't have much waveclear yet, you can start autoing the wave. Since your wave is bigger, even if they are also autoing the wave their wave will die faster than your wave. This means they either give up controlling the wave and letting you slowly push or

they use spells on the wave (could be Ahri Q but or could be a shitty Veigar W, doesn't really matter). Now that you have ability advantage you can walk up past their minion wave but still autoing the wave. They have to back up, because if you don't, you can E1 -> AA -> Q -> AA -> W -> AA and you don't even have to hit your E2 to win the trade since they're down an ability.

Taking a good trade is nice but most of the time they just back up. Then you just keep autoing the wave, your goal is to shove the biggest wave under their tower as possible. Once you shove it under their tower, you can recall. Usually getting a good first recall as a melee vs ranged matchup is very very important.

[Comment 4 | Score: 7]

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=o_8j_73WqOc](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=o_8j_73WqOc)

[Comment 5 | Score: 3]

The vast majority of that advice you're hearing is top/bot lane advice. Not mid. Hell the entire identity of many mids is to delete the wave immediately and roam. That's why mid is home to control mages.

There's still **some** use in some of it. Being a Sylas main(melee) there's some truth to not using abilities on waves and last hitting. But you need to know when and why.

For example, say you're facing a ranged mage. If you q the wave and it's now pushing to your enemy, you might have a really hard time farming and making the wave crash. And you won't be able to harass them cause they can farm the wave from safety of turret.

Think of it more like a tempo game. If your enemy laner is hitting the wave, you have permission to

hit the wave too. If you're ONLY last hitting, and the enemy mid is hitting the wave, it's going to push faster than yours and crash. Likewise, if you're hitting the wave, and not pushing it fast enough, they can hold the wave in front of their turret.

You want to think constantly about "where" you want the wave to be.

1. You wanna roam? That means you wanna delete the wave asap so it crashes under turret/you don't have minions hitting your turret.
2. Enemy stronger than you? You want to only hit the wave enough so it doesn't crash under your turret. Keep the wave on your side of the lane.
3. You're stronger than the enemy? You either want the wave in the middle, or on your side of the lane. In both options you are making sure there's space for you to fight and deny CS without putting yourself under turret or vulnerable to ganks.

There's almost no point in mid you want to "slow push". That's typically used in very niche scenarios for dives and is difficult to even set up in mid, and not typically a very big wave crash. You can easily get to like Diamond+ without ever "slow pushing" midlane.

So think about those scenarios. And understand how waves work. You have 5 minions to 6 enemy minions, wave will push toward you. You have 6 minions to enemy 5 minions, wave will push away from you. The bigger the discrepancy is, the *faster* that "push" is gonna be.

That's how you decide if using abilities/hitting the wave is worth it. You think first about where you WANT the wave to be, and then look at the minions and do what you need to make that happen.